

Multimodal visual localization application

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1. Concept Introduction

1.1 What is "Multimodal visual localization"?

Multimodal visual localization is a technology that combines multiple sensor inputs (such as cameras, depth sensors, IMUs, etc.) and algorithmic processing techniques to achieve precise identification and tracking of the location and posture of devices or users in their environment. This technology does not rely solely on a single type of sensor data but integrates information from different perceptual modalities, thereby improving the accuracy and robustness of positioning.

1.2 Brief Description of Implementation Principles

1. **Cross-modal Representation Learning:** To enable LLMs to process visual information, a mechanism needs to be developed to convert visual signals into a form that the model can understand. This may involve using convolutional neural networks (CNNs) or other image-processing-appropriate architectures to extract features and map them into the same embedding space as the text.
 2. **Joint Training:** By designing an appropriate loss function, text and visual data can be trained simultaneously within the same framework, allowing the model to learn to establish connections between the two modalities. For example, in a question-answering system, answers can be provided based on both text questions and related image content.
 3. **Visually Guided Language Generation/Understanding:** Once an effective cross-modal representation is established, visual information can be used to enhance the functionality of the language model. For instance, given a photograph, the model can not only describe what is happening in the image, but also answer specific questions about the scene, and even execute instructions based on visual cues (such as navigating to a location).
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2. Code Analysis

Key Code

1. Utility Layer Entry Point (`largemodel/utis/tools_manager.py`)

The `visual_positioning` function in this file defines the execution flow of the tool, specifically how it constructs a Prompt containing the target object's name and formatting requirements.

```
# From largemodel/utis/tools_manager.py
class ToolsManager:
    # ...
    def visual_positioning(self, args):
        """
        Locate object coordinates in image and save results to MD file.

        :param args: Arguments containing image path and object name.
        :return: Dictionary with file path and coordinate data.
        """
        self.node.get_logger().info(f"Executing visual_positioning() tool with
args: {args}")
        try:
            image_path = args.get("image_path")
            object_name = args.get("object_name")
            # ... (Path fallback mechanism and parameter check)

            # Construct a prompt asking the large model to identify the
coordinates of the specified object.
            if self.node.language == 'zh':
                prompt = f"请仔细分析这张图片，用一个个框定位图像每一个{object_name}的位
置..."
            else:
                prompt = f"Please carefully analyze this image and find the
position of all {object_name}..."

            # ... (Building an independent message context)

            result = self.node.model_client.infer_with_image(image_path, prompt,
message=message_to_use)

            # ... (Processing and parsing the returned coordinate text)

            return {
                "file_path": md_file_path,
                "coordinates_content": coordinates_content,
                "explanation_content": explanation_content
            }
        # ... (Error handling)
```

2. Model Interface Layer

(`largemodel/utils/large_model_interface.py`)

The `infer_with_image` function in this file is the unified entry point for all image-related tasks.

```
# From largemodel/utils/large_model_interface.py

class model_interface:
    # ...
    def infer_with_image(self, image_path, text=None, message=None):
        """Unified image inference interface. """
        # ... (Preparing the message)
        try:
            # The value of self.llm_platform determines which specific
            implementation to call.
            if self.llm_platform == 'ollama':
                response_content = self.ollama_infer(self.messages,
image_path=image_path)
            elif self.llm_platform == 'tongyi':
                # ... Logic of calling the generalized model
                pass
            # ... (Logic for other platforms)
            # ...
            return {'response': response_content, 'messages': self.messages.copy()}
```

Code Analysis

The core of the visual positioning function lies in **guiding a large model to output structured data through precise instructions**. It also follows a layered design of tool layer and model interface layer.

1. Tool Layer (`tools_manager.py`):

- The `visual_positioning` function is the core of this function's business logic. It receives two key parameters: `image_path` (image path) and `object_name` (the name of the object to be positioned).
- The most crucial operation of this function is **constructing a highly customized Prompt**. It doesn't simply request the model to describe the image; instead, it embeds `object_name` into a carefully designed template, explicitly instructing the model to "position each {object_name} in the image," and implicitly or explicitly requesting the return of results in a specific format (such as a coordinate array).
- After constructing the Prompt, it calls the `infer_with_image` method of the model interface layer, passing the image and this customized instruction along with it.
- After receiving the returned text from the model interface layer, it still needs to perform **post-processing**: using methods such as regular expressions to parse precise coordinate data from the model's natural language response.
- Finally, it returns the parsed structured coordinate data to the upper-layer application.

2. Model Interface Layer (`large_model_interface.py`):

- The `infer_with_image` function still plays the role of the "dispatch center." It receives the image and prompt from `visual_positioning` and distributes the task to the correct backend model implementation based on the current configuration (`self.llm_platform`).
- For visual positioning tasks, the model interface layer's responsibilities are essentially the same as for visual understanding tasks: correctly package the image data and text

instructions, send them to the selected model platform, and then return the text results intact to the tool layer. All platform-specific implementation details are encapsulated in this layer.

In summary, the general workflow for visual localization is as follows: `ToolsManager` receives the target object name and constructs a precise Prompt that requests coordinates -> `ToolsManager` calls the model interface -> `model_interface` packages the image and the Prompt together and sends it to the appropriate model platform according to the configuration -> The model returns text containing coordinate information -> `model_interface` returns the text to `ToolsManager` -> `ToolsManager` parses the text, extracts the structured coordinate data, and returns it. This process demonstrates how Prompt Engineering techniques enable general-purpose large-scale visual models to perform more specific and structured tasks.

3. Practical Operation

3.1 Configuring the Offline Large Model

3.1.1 Configuring the LLM Platform (`yahboom.yaml`)

This file determines which large model platform the `model_service` node loads as its primary language model.

1. Open the file in the terminal:

```
vim ~/yahboom_ws/install/largemodel/share/largemodel/config/yahboom.yaml
```

2. Modify / confirm `llm_platform`:

```
model_service:                                #Model server node parameters
  ros__parameters:
    language: 'en'                             #Large Model Interface Language
    useolinetts: True                         #This option is invalid in text mode
    and can be ignored.

# Large Model Configuration
llm_platform: 'ollama'                        # Key point: Make sure this is 'ollama'
```

3.1.2 Configuring the Model Interface (`large_model_interface.yaml`)

This file defines which vision model to use when the platform is selected as `ollama`.

1. Open the file in the terminal.

```
vim
~/yahboom_ws/install/largemodel/share/largemodel/config/large_model_interface.
yaml
```

2. Locate the ollama-related configurations.

```
#.....  
## Offline Large Language Models  
# Ollama Configuration  
ollama_host: "http://localhost:11434" # Ollama server address  
ollama_model: "llava" # Key: Replace this with your downloaded multimodal model,  
such as "llava"  
#.....
```

Note: Please ensure that the model specified in the configuration parameters (e.g., `llava`) can handle multimodal input.

3.2 Launching and Testing the Feature (Text Mode)

1. Preparing the Image File:

Place the image file to be tested in the following path:

```
/home/sunrise/yahboom_ws/src/largemodel/resources_file/visual_positioning
```

Then name the image `test_image.jpg`

2. Launch the `largemodel` main program (Text Mode):

Open a terminal and run the following command:

```
ros2 launch largemodel largemodel_control.launch.py text_chat_mode:=true
```

3. Sending Text Commands:

Open another terminal and run the following command:

```
ros2 run text_chat text_chat
```

Then start typing the text: "Analyze the position of the dinosaur in the image."

4. Observation Results:

In the first terminal running the main program, you will see log output showing that the system received the command, called the `visual_positioning` tool, and indicated that `visual_positioning` had completed execution and saved the coordinates to a file.

This file can be found at `~/yahboom_ws/src/largemodel/resources_file/visual_positioning`.

4. Common Problems and Solutions

Problem 1: "Image file not found" error message

Solution:

1. **Check Path:** Ensure you have placed the image file in the specified path, named `test_image.jpg`, and have permission to read the file.
2. **Image Format:** Ensure the image file is not corrupted and is in .jpg format.

